

STATEMENT OF WORK

Payments Control System

Functional Scope

1. Core Platform and Master Data

The platform provides the foundational data structures and configuration capabilities on which all workflows depend. Master data is maintained centrally and is subject to effective-dated versioning so that historical transactions always retain reference to the configuration active at the time.

1.1 Entities and Organisational Structure

- Hierarchical model of group, legal entity, country, business unit, and department.
- Mapping of users to one or more entities and roles.
- Per-entity attributes: country, base currency, owned bank accounts, applicable approval matrix configuration.

1.2 Payment Types

- Configurable catalogue of payment types, including vendor payment, payroll, reimbursement, full-and-final settlement, incoming receipt, and chairman payment. Each payment type carries its own workflow behaviour, approval matrix, document attachment policy, and field-level configuration.

1.3 Counterparty Master (Vendors and Customers)

- A unified counterparty master in which each record carries a role attribute of vendor, customer, or both.
- Counterparty record holds name, registered details, tax identifiers (TRN, GSTIN, VAT registration, etc.), country, addresses, and primary contact.
- Each counterparty is linked to one or more beneficiary bank accounts held in the beneficiary master (see Section 6). Accounts are direction-tagged as pay-to (outgoing) and/or receive-from (incoming) so that entities maintaining separate accounts for each direction are modelled cleanly.
- Maintained by authorised administrators. Changes to linked bank accounts flow through the bank account change control workflow (see Section 6).

1.4 Employee Master

- Employee identifier, name, employing entity, country, base currency, payroll category, and linked employee bank account.
- Sensitive payroll attributes are masked by default and visible only to users holding the appropriate role.
- The maker may change an employee's bank account on the basis of an emailed request from the employee, subject to the controls described in Section 7.4.

1.5 Approval Matrix Configuration

- Per-payment-type matrix expressed as currency-native bands (for example, INR 0 to 500,000, INR 500,001 to 2,000,000, INR 2,000,001 and above), each mapped to a sequential chain of approvers.
- Matrix versioning with effective dates. Changes to the matrix do not affect requests already in flight.

1.6 Sanctioned-Country Master

- Admin-maintained list of sanctioned countries used to screen beneficiaries (see Section 6.5). An authorised administrator adds or removes countries; every change is logged with user, timestamp, and reason.

2. Currency, Bank, and Account Master

The system maintains a structured master of currencies, banks, and the group's own bank accounts. This master underpins source-account selection during payment preparation and the balance and minimum-balance controls.

2.1 Currency Master

- Currency master with ISO 4217 codes and an active flag per currency.
- USD is the group reporting currency for consolidated views. Approval thresholds are defined in native currency and are not subject to FX conversion.

2.2 Foreign Exchange Rates

- Daily foreign exchange rates are fetched automatically from an external rates provider. The provider is the OANDA Exchange Rates API. The rate source is abstracted behind a service interface so that the provider can be substituted without rework.
- Rates are used for display of USD-equivalent values on consolidated dashboards and for the indicative cross-currency minimum-balance check (see Section 2.5).
- Where the rate feed is unavailable on a given day, the system holds the previous day's rates and displays a visible 'stale rate, last updated [date]' indicator wherever the rate is used. An authorised administrator may manually override the rate for the day; every override is logged.

2.3 Bank Master

- Master of banks with which the group holds relationships, carrying bank name, country, and identifying codes (SWIFT/BIC) where applicable.

2.4 Account Master

- Each bank account belongs to exactly one bank, one currency, and one legal entity within the group.
- Account type, one of: **Current** (operational; used for outgoing TT payments and incoming receipts), **Collateral** (used only for letter-of-credit payments as and when they arise; never selectable for TT payments), and **Deposit** (term deposits arising from collateralised finance; never used for any payment or receipt; held for visibility of balances only).
- Each account stores its current balance, seeded at go-live, together with the as-of timestamp and the source of the last update (system-computed, statement-reconciled, or manual override).
- Current accounts additionally store a minimum balance requirement. Minimum balance is not applicable to collateral or deposit accounts.

- Deposit account balances are maintained manually by an authorised administrator (for example, on interest accrual, renewal, or redemption), with every change logged. No workflow debits or credits a deposit account.

2.5 Balance Maintenance and Minimum-Balance Control

- The system maintains a running balance per account. The balance is debited when an outgoing payment from that account is marked Paid and credited when an incoming receipt to that account is marked Received.
- On the weekly bank statement upload (see Section 8), the recorded balance is reset to the statement's closing balance. The reset is logged as a reconciliation adjustment in the audit trail.
- A user with sufficient rights may manually override the recorded balance at any point between reconciliations. Every override is logged with user, timestamp, previous value, new value, and reason.
- When preparing an outgoing TT, the maker specifies the payment currency. The system presents only those current accounts of the relevant entity that operate in that currency.
- The system blocks the payment where releasing it would cause the source account balance to fall below its minimum balance requirement.

2.6 Cross-Currency Payments

- Where the entity holds no current account in the payment currency, the maker may select a current account in another currency. The system marks the request as a cross-currency payment and displays both the payment-currency amount and the indicative source-currency equivalent at the day's rate before the maker confirms, with a note that the final rate is bank-determined.
- The minimum-balance check for a cross-currency payment is evaluated on the indicative source-currency equivalent.
- **Post-execution amount correction.** Because the actual amount debited depends on the bank's remittance rate, the maker (or higher) may edit the recorded debit amount after execution to match the actual figure. The correction requires the proof of payment to be attached, and is captured in the audit trail with the original indicative amount, the corrected amount, and the variance. The amount may be edited while the request is in Paid status; once the debit is matched against an uploaded bank statement, the amount is locked to the statement value.

3. Payment Lifecycle

Outgoing payments follow the lifecycle below. The lifecycle is the canonical flow against which the vendor, payroll, reimbursement, full-and-final, and chairman payment workflows are specialised.

1. The user who requires a payment creates a payment request, attaching the relevant supporting document (invoice, payslip, claim, or settlement letter as applicable).
2. The request passes through the sequential chain of approval defined by the matrix for its payment type, currency, and amount.
3. Once all approvers have approved, the request is received by a Maker in the payments team.
4. The Maker verifies all documents against the approval before preparing the international telegraphic transfer (TT).
5. Where the payment is to an existing, verified beneficiary account, the Maker proceeds without further beneficiary controls.
6. Where a beneficiary is being added to the system for the first time, beneficiary verification is performed and a cooling-off period applies before a payment may be made to that beneficiary (see Section 6).
7. Where the counterparty already exists as a verified beneficiary on another account of the group and the current payment must be made from a new account, the Maker takes the beneficiary details from the master and associates them with the new account. No cooling-off period applies where the destination account details are copied unchanged from the existing verified record. Standard change control and cooling-off apply if a new destination account number is introduced.

The status model for a request is: Draft, Pending Approval, Approved, Awaiting Payment Confirmation, Paid, Rejected, Withdrawn, and Cancelled (Admin). The Maker marks a request Awaiting Payment Confirmation on release to the bank, captures the bank reference and value date to move it to Paid, and attaches proof of payment by end of day (see Section 4.4).

4. Vendor Payment Workflow

Vendor payments originate from supplier invoices received by the various business teams. The system supports both manual capture and AI-assisted capture through invoice optical character recognition (see Section 12).

4.1 Request Creation

- The initiator selects the payment type, counterparty (from the counterparty master), invoice details, amount, currency, due date, and the destination beneficiary account, selected from the locked list of accounts linked to the counterparty. Free-typing of account numbers is not permitted under any circumstance.
- **Invoice number.** The invoice number is an alphanumeric field; spaces are not permitted. The system extracts the value it identifies as the invoice number from the uploaded document and presents it in an editable text field. The user confirms the extracted value or edits it to match the document.
- Mandatory attachments per payment type are enforced. The default attachment set for vendor invoices: invoice PDF, purchase order where applicable, goods receipt note or service acceptance where applicable, and the counterparty master snapshot (auto-generated by the system).
- Where the payment amount exceeds a configurable threshold, additional documents may be made mandatory by payment type configuration.

4.2 Approver View

When an approver opens a vendor payment request on the mobile application, the request screen displays the payment header (counterparty, amount, currency, due date), the destination bank account visually highlighted, the attached documents accessible in-app, the counterparty master snapshot, the counterparty's recent payment history with the group, and any sanctions or anomaly warnings raised against the request. The approver copilot is available on this screen.

4.3 Maker Verification and Execution

- On full approval, the request reaches a payments team Maker, who verifies all documents against the approval before preparing the TT.
- The Maker selects the source account (filtered by currency and entity; subject to the minimum-balance control of Section 2.5) and prepares the transfer in the relevant bank portal outside the system.

4.4 Post-Approval and Proof of Payment

- The Maker marks the request Awaiting Payment Confirmation on release, then captures the bank reference (UTR / wire reference / transaction ID) and value date to move it to Paid. The account balance updates on the Paid event.
- **Proof of payment.** By end of day, a proof of payment must be attached against every request processed that day, being a SWIFT MT103 copy, debit advice PDF, bank portal screenshot, or local clearing acknowledgement. Marking a request Paid during the day requires the bank reference; an end-of-day exception report lists any Paid request still missing its proof of payment and is sent automatically to the designated supervisor (defaulting to the country Finance Head).

5. Payroll, Reimbursement, and Full-and-Final Workflows

Human resources initiates payroll, reimbursement, and full-and-final settlement requests as a regular user. The payslip plays the same role for payroll that the invoice plays for vendor payments. All statutory computations, including Singapore CPF and China Social Security contributions, are performed by HR at the time of submission; the system records the supplied figures and does not compute or interpret statutory rules.

5.1 Payroll Bulk Upload

- HR uploads salary payment requests in bulk through a standard template, creating one payment request per employee. A payslip is attached for every employee; payslips are mandatory for all employees before payment is processed.
- Files are validated on upload. Validation failures (missing payslips, invalid employee identifiers, currency mismatches, malformed values) are surfaced immediately and the upload is rejected for resubmission.
- The system links each created request to the corresponding employee record and employee bank account.

5.2 Approval

- Payroll approval is given at batch level by a designated approver role before the payments team processes it. A single batch approval authorises all underlying requests, each of which retains its own audit trail.
- The approval view presents a summary (headcount, total gross, total deductions, total net, breakdown by entity and country) with the ability to drill down to entity, department, and individual employee. Drill-down is read-only on mobile.

5.3 Advisory Sanity Controls

- Per-employee net pay variance against the prior month (configurable threshold, default plus or minus 10 per cent).
- Per-batch variance against the prior month's totals at company level.
- Headcount change detection (new joiners and leavers).
- These controls flag outliers for the approver's attention. They do not compute or alter any figure. AI-driven anomaly detection on the batch is described in Section 12.

5.4 Employee Bank Account Changes

- The Maker may change an employee's bank account on the basis of an emailed request from the employee. Proof of the change request must be uploaded.

- The change is subject to maker-checker (the user requesting the change cannot also approve it) and to a cooling-off period before the new account may receive a payment (default 24 hours, configurable).
- Anomaly flags apply: name mismatch between payslip and the new account holder, multiple changes within a short window, and changes requested immediately before a payroll run.

5.5 Processing by the Payments Team

- The payments team Maker processes approved salary payments company-wise as a batch, executing each transfer to the employee's account.

5.6 Reimbursement and Full-and-Final Settlement

- Reimbursements and full-and-final (FnF) settlements are raised by HR as ordinary requests through the standard approval matrix, with the relevant supporting document (claim form for reimbursement; settlement letter for FnF).
- End-of-service and gratuity amounts are computed by HR and surface only at FnF time. The system performs no monthly accrual or provisioning of these amounts.

6. Beneficiary Master and Bank Account Change Control

Beneficiary bank account changes are the highest-risk event in the payments environment. The system treats them as a first-class workflow distinct from ordinary payment approval, with stricter controls.

6.1 Beneficiary Master

- Beneficiary bank accounts for counterparties and employees, each record carrying account holder name, account number, bank, branch / SWIFT / IBAN as applicable, currency, status (active / inactive / pending activation), and full change history.
- Every payment request must select the destination account from this master. The user interface does not permit free-typing of an account number on a payment request under any circumstance.
- Inactive accounts and accounts in pending-activation status (within the cooling-off window) cannot be selected for payment.

6.2 Bank Account Change Request Workflow

- Adding a new beneficiary account or modifying an existing one creates a Bank Account Change Request, routed through a dedicated workflow independent of the payment approval matrix.
- Mandatory supporting documents: cancelled cheque or bank letter on the bank's letterhead, written request from the counterparty on its letterhead, and the source correspondence.
- Maker-checker is enforced: the user creating the change request cannot be the user who verifies it.
- **Callback verification.** The checker records evidence of an independent verification call to the counterparty on a number sourced independently of the change request. The system presents this as a mandatory checklist item with timestamp and notes; it does not place the call.
- Final approval of the change request is routed to a higher authority than the equivalent payment-amount threshold would require.

6.3 Cooling-off Period

- Newly added or modified accounts enter pending-activation status on final approval and cannot be used for payment until a configurable cooling-off period (default 24 hours) has elapsed, after which they auto-activate.
- Where a counterparty already exists as a verified beneficiary on another account of the group and a payment must be made from a new source account, the beneficiary details may be copied unchanged from the existing verified record with no cooling-off. A new destination account number introduces standard change control and cooling-off.
- Administrators may override the cooling-off period in defined circumstances; every override is logged.

6.4 Anomaly Flagging

Bank account change requests are evaluated by the anomaly detection module (see Section 12). Signals include similar-looking account numbers, name mismatches against the master, multiple changes to the same counterparty within a short window, changes immediately followed by large payment requests, and changes originating from unexpected email domains.

6.5 Sanctioned-Country Screening

- Each beneficiary is screened against the sanctioned-country master (Section 1.6) on the basis of the beneficiary's country.
- Where the country is sanctioned, a soft warning is shown: the Maker and every approver see a prominent warning on the request, and the final approver must explicitly acknowledge the flag with a mandatory comment before approval registers. The acknowledgement is logged and surfaced in a sanctions-override report.
- Screening is at country level in this scope. Entity-level and individual name screening against published sanctions lists may be added later through integration with a specialist screening service.

7. Incoming Receipts

Incoming receipts are the inbound counterpart of outgoing payments. They record amounts the group expects to receive from counterparties and confirm those amounts against bank credits.

7.1 Request Creation

- An initiator creates an incoming receipt request, selecting the counterparty and attaching the debit note or final invoice that is shared with the counterparty.
- The request records the expected amount, currency, and the receive-from account.

7.2 No Approval Chain

- Incoming receipts do not pass through an approval chain. The payments team (accounts) reviews the attached documents for completeness and accuracy.

7.3 Marking the Credit Received

- When the credit lands, the payments team marks the receipt as received, capturing the received date, the inward bank reference, the received amount, and the received currency, with optional remarks.
- The recorded balance of the receiving account is credited on the Received event.
- On marking the receipt received, the initiator who raised the request is notified by email.

7.4 Reconciliation

- Incoming receipts are reconciled against credit entries on the bank statement in the same manner as outgoing payments are reconciled against debits (see Section 8).

8. Bank Statement Reconciliation and Exception Management

Because the system does not execute payments, a control mechanism is required to detect any movement on a group bank account without a corresponding record in the system. This is delivered through the reconciliation module, which covers both debit and credit entries.

8.1 Statement Ingestion

- Bank statements are uploaded into the system by the payments team on a weekly cadence.
- Supported formats: CSV with a configurable column mapping per bank, and PDF statements parsed via the OCR layer where the bank does not provide structured exports.
- On upload, each account's recorded balance is reset to the statement's closing balance (see Section 2.5).

8.2 Auto-Matching

- Each debit entry is matched against outgoing requests in Paid status, and each credit entry against incoming receipts marked Received, using amount, value date, beneficiary or counterparty, and bank reference.
- The matcher produces three outcomes per line: matched, candidate match (presented for human confirmation), and unmatched (escalated as an exception).

8.3 Exception Management

- Every unmatched debit becomes an Unauthorised Payment Exception. Every unmatched credit becomes an Unidentified Receipt Exception. Exceptions are routed to a configured group of senior users for investigation.
- Each exception carries a workflow with statuses (Open, Under Investigation, Resolved with Justification, Confirmed Exception) and a mandatory resolution note before closure.

9. Chairman Payments

Chairman payments are a dedicated, confidential payment type with controls and visibility rules distinct from all other payments.

9.1 Initiation

- The chairman initiates a chairman payment directly from the mobile application. This is the only initiation permitted on mobile; all other initiation occurs on the web application.
- Chairman payments do not pass through an approval chain. The chairman is the sole authority for the request.

9.2 Execution Control

- On initiation, the request goes to the payments team. The Maker prepares the TT and the Checker verifies the documents; the Payments Head approves execution before the transfer is released.
- The Maker may select the source account only from the designated set of chairman-payment accounts. Those designated accounts cannot be selected as the source for any non-chairman payment.

9.3 Confidentiality

- The real beneficiary identity is visible only to the Maker, the Checker, and the Payments Head.
- Everywhere else in the system (other approvers, country and entity finance heads, group dashboards, group reports, and the internal auditor view) the beneficiary is rendered discreetly, with amount, currency, date, and source account visible but the identity suppressed.
- Chairman payment beneficiaries are held in a segregated beneficiary master visible only to the Maker, Checker, and Payments Head, subject to the same change-control rigour as the standard master (maker-checker, callback verification, cooling-off, sanctions screening).

9.4 Reconciliation Visibility

- Bank statement entries against chairman-designated accounts are visible in the reconciliation module only to the Maker, Checker, and Payments Head.

10. Mobile Application

The mobile application is the channel through which approvers act and through which the chairman initiates chairman payments. It is delivered natively for both iOS and Android.

10.1 Authentication and Device Security

- First-time login binds the application instance to the specific device. Re-binding to a new device requires administrator re-enrolment.
- Authentication on a bound device is gated by the device's native biometric (Face ID, Touch ID, fingerprint), falling back to device passcode. Loss of both requires administrator re-enrolment.
- Session timeout is configurable; default 15 minutes of inactivity.

10.2 Functional Scope

- Pending approvals list, sorted by age.
- Request detail view with all attachments accessible in-app, including PDF viewing, and any sanctions or anomaly warnings.
- Approve, Reject (with mandatory comment), and Request Information (returns to initiator with a note).
- Batch-level approval for payroll.
- Chairman payment initiation (chairman role only).
- History of the user's recent decisions, approver copilot, delegation management, push notifications, and daily digest receipt.

10.3 Out of Scope on Mobile

- All initiation other than chairman payments, master data maintenance, configuration, reconciliation operations, and reporting beyond the user's own activity are performed exclusively on the web application.

11. Web Application and Notifications

11.1 Web Application Functional Areas

- Request initiation for vendor payments, payroll, reimbursement, FnF, and incoming receipts.
- Master data maintenance (counterparties, employees, beneficiaries, banks, accounts, payment types, approval matrices, sanctioned countries, currencies, users and roles).
- Maker operations: document verification, source-account selection, marking payments released and paid, proof-of-payment upload, and post-execution amount correction.
- Reconciliation operations (statement upload, matching confirmation, exception management).
- Dashboards, reports, audit log review and export, and system configuration.
- Approvers may use the web application in read-only mode; approval, rejection, and delegation actions are available only on mobile.

11.2 Authentication

- Single sign-on integration with the client's identity provider via SAML 2.0 or OpenID Connect. Local authentication with enforced password policy and TOTP-based MFA is supported as a fallback where SSO is unavailable for a user.

11.3 Notifications

- Two channels only: push notifications to the mobile application and email.
- Approvers receive a real-time push and parallel email on first arrival of a request, plus a single daily digest at the configured local time (default 09:00) listing pending items sorted by age, sent only on days with at least one pending item.
- Initiators receive a real-time email at every state transition of their request: submitted, approved at each level, fully approved, rejected, released to bank, paid, and reconciled. Incoming receipt initiators are notified when the credit is marked received.
- Administrators are notified of out-of-hours master data changes, repeated failed logins, cooling-off overrides, and reconciliation exceptions.

12. AI Capabilities

Artificial intelligence is applied to specific, well-bounded problems within the payments workflow. The system uses the Anthropic Claude API as the underlying language model service. AI features assist humans; no AI capability has the authority to approve a payment.

12.1 Invoice OCR and Data Extraction

- On upload of an invoice PDF, the system extracts counterparty name and address, invoice number, dates, line items, taxes, and total amount, and pre-populates the request form. The invoice number is presented as an editable alphanumeric field (no spaces) for the initiator to confirm or correct.
- The original document is retained, and the audit trail records both the extracted values and any edits.

12.2 Duplicate Invoice Detection

- On submission, the request is evaluated against historical records for duplicates: exact match on counterparty plus invoice number, and high-similarity match on counterparty, amount, and date within a configurable window.
- Suspected duplicates are flagged to the initiator and to every approver; the flag requires acknowledgement but does not block submission.

12.3 Bank Account Change Anomaly Detection

- Every Bank Account Change Request is evaluated against configurable anomaly signals (account-number similarity, name mismatch, change frequency, magnitude of expected payments, originating email domain) before routing to the verifier. Signals are surfaced to the verifier and final approver and captured in the permanent record.

12.4 Payroll Anomaly Detection

- Each payroll batch is evaluated against historical baselines: headcount, total gross and net per entity and country, per-employee net variance, deduction-to-gross ratio outliers, and identification of joiners, leavers, and material changes. Signals are surfaced on the batch summary.

12.5 Approver Copilot

- Within each request detail view on mobile, an in-context assistant operates on the structured data of the request and its surrounding context (counterparty master, payment history, prior approvals, related requests).

- It answers questions such as summarising the request, recent payment history with the counterparty, whether the destination account changed recently, other pending requests for the counterparty, and what risk signals the system has flagged. The copilot is read-only and cannot act on the request. Every interaction is logged.

12.6 Data Handling for AI

- Inference calls to the Anthropic Claude API are configured for zero data retention; customer data is not used to train models.
- Personally identifiable information from the payroll domain is redacted or tokenised before inclusion in any inference call.
- AI outputs are advisory and are surfaced to humans for review; AI does not make approval decisions.

13. Dashboards and Reporting

Each role sees a tailored dashboard. The system ships with a standard report library; reports run on demand and can be scheduled for delivery to a distribution list. Exports are available in CSV and PDF formats.

13.1 Role-Specific Dashboards

Role	Dashboard scope
Initiator	My submitted requests and receipts, current status, aging, items needing rework.
Approver	Pending my approval (mobile primary, web read-only), recently actioned, delegated to me.
Country / Entity Finance Head	All activity in my scope, by status, category, and currency, with aging; payroll status; account balances; proof-of-payment exceptions; reconciliation exceptions.
Group CFO / Treasurer	Group-wide view in USD-equivalent, by country, category, and bank; account balances; top counterparties; outstanding exceptions. Chairman payments appear discreetly.
Payments Team (Maker / Checker / Head)	Approved items awaiting execution, items awaiting proof of payment, beneficiary change requests, reconciliation queue, account balances.
Internal Auditor	Read-only access across the system, including the full audit log. Chairman payment beneficiaries appear discreetly.
System Administrator	User activity, configuration and master data change logs, failed logins, system health.

13.2 Standard Report Library

- Pending approvals aging report (by approver, country, category, payment type).
- Approver service-level performance report, with month-on-month trend.
- Payments approved report, sliced by country, entity, payment type, currency, and bank, with USD-equivalent totals.
- Incoming receipts report and outstanding (awaited) receipts report.
- Account balances report, with minimum-balance status for current accounts and balances of collateral and deposit accounts.

- Beneficiary master change log report, including cooling-off overrides.
- Sanctions-override report.
- Proof-of-payment exception report (end-of-day).
- Reconciliation exception report (unauthorised payments and unidentified receipts).
- Payroll register, by month and entity, with variance against prior month.
- Bank account change anomaly report (AI-flagged items).
- User activity report.

13.3 Scheduled Delivery

- Any report may be scheduled by an authorised user for daily, weekly, or monthly delivery to a defined distribution list, delivered as CSV or PDF attachments by email.

14. User Roles and Access Control

The system supports the following standard roles. A user may hold one or more roles within the constraints of segregation-of-duties rules.

Role	Description
Payments Initiator	Creates vendor payment requests and incoming receipt requests. No approval authority.
HR Initiator	Bulk-uploads payroll, creates reimbursement and FnF requests. No approval authority.
Approver	Approves on mobile against requests routed by the matrix. Read-only on web.
Payroll Approver	Designated role giving batch-level approval of payroll before processing.
Payments Team Maker	Verifies documents, prepares TTs, selects source account, marks released and paid, uploads proof of payment, performs post-execution amount correction.
Payments Team Checker	Verifies documents on chairman payments and on beneficiary change requests; cannot verify own creations.
Payments Head	Approves execution of chairman payments. Senior payments-team oversight.
Beneficiary Change Maker / Verifier	Create and verify bank account change requests under maker-checker; the two cannot be the same user.
Country / Entity Finance Head	Reviews and reports within entity or country scope. Default recipient of proof-of-payment exceptions.
Group Treasurer / CFO	Group-wide visibility and reporting; recipient group for reconciliation exceptions.
Chairman	Initiates chairman payments on mobile.
Internal Auditor	Read-only access across the system, including the full audit log.
System Administrator	User management, master data, matrix and account configuration, sanctioned-country list, balance override.

Role	Description
Super Administrator	Highest privilege; administrative reassignment, cooling-off overrides, emergency operations. Segregated from business roles; actions under dual control.

14.1 Segregation of Duties

- A Beneficiary Change Maker cannot also be the Verifier of the same change. A Payments Team Maker cannot be the Checker on the same chairman payment.
- Initiators cannot approve their own requests. Super Administrators cannot simultaneously hold Approver or Payments Team roles.
- All actions are scoped to the user's entity and country assignments; cross-entity access is granted explicitly.

15. Audit, Security, and Access Controls

15.1 Audit Trail

- Every state-changing action is immutably logged: submission, every approval and rejection, delegation and administrative reassignment, master data and configuration changes, balance updates and overrides, post-execution amount corrections, beneficiary change actions, sanctions acknowledgements, reconciliation outcomes, and chairman-payment access events.
- Each entry captures user, timestamp (UTC), source IP, device identifier where applicable, action, before-and-after values where applicable, and reason where applicable.
- The audit log is queryable by authorised users and exportable in CSV format.

15.2 Access Control and Data Protection

- Role-based access control with segregation of duties enforced at the role-definition level.
- Data in transit encrypted using TLS 1.2 or higher; data at rest encrypted using AES-256 or equivalent.
- Payroll personally identifiable information is masked by default and access-controlled at field level; unmasking requires the Payroll PII Access permission and is logged.

15.3 Session Management

- Configurable session timeout for web and mobile; forced re-authentication for sensitive actions including beneficiary change approvals and master data modifications.